

Argument as a Method

Teach students to think with knowledge — not just remember it.

Riga, Latvia · 6 days · English · €480 per participant · 6–16 participants · No debate experience required

A practical 6-day Erasmus+ teacher training course on using argumentation, evidence and structured disagreement as tools for learning across subjects. Instead of explaining a new topic first and asking students to discuss it afterwards, teachers learn how to make questioning, argument, evidence and disagreement part of the learning process itself.

Who is this course for?

Subject teachers, language teachers, humanities and social science teachers, interdisciplinary educators, school leaders and educators interested in competence-based learning. No previous debate experience is required — this is not competitive debating training.

What you will learn

- Transform curriculum topics into strong questions, dilemmas and problems for exploration
- Use debate and structured argumentation to introduce new knowledge, not only revise it
- Teach students to distinguish claims, reasoning, evidence and assumptions
- Move classroom discussion from "I agree / I disagree" towards genuine analysis
- Teach rebuttal, comparison and evaluation of competing explanations
- Design debate-based activities for different subjects, ages and ability levels
- Involve quieter students without turning every lesson into public speaking
- Assess both subject understanding and quality of reasoning
- Recognise weak arguments, logical gaps and unsupported claims
- Create a classroom-ready, debate-based lesson of their own

The 6-day programme

Day 1 — Why Argument Helps Students Learn

Why disagreement can improve understanding; discussion vs. debate vs. argumentation; claims, reasons, evidence and assumptions.

Day 2 — Turning Curriculum into Questions

Identifying the tension, choice or competing explanation hidden inside an ordinary curriculum topic, with real examples across subjects.

Day 3 — From Opinion to Evidence

Moving students from "I think" to "I can justify": evidence, source quality, assumptions, causal reasoning, counterarguments.

Day 4 — The Classroom Debate Lab

Short argument exercises, structured academic controversy, role-based discussion, decision-making simulations, mini-debates.

Day 5 — Designing Your Own Debate-Based Lesson

Participants redesign a real topic from their own curriculum and test elements of it with the group.

Day 6 — Riga Learning Experience

An educational and cultural day in Riga, with reflection, informal exchange, and networking with educators from other European countries.

What you take home

A practical teaching toolkit — debate-based lesson structures, an argument-building framework, tools for teaching rebuttal and comparison, question and motion design templates, classroom activity formats, assessment ideas and a complete lesson developed during the course — plus the course programme, documented learning outcomes and a Certificate of Attendance.

Course details

Location	Riga, Latvia
Language	English
Duration	6 days
Format	Face-to-face
Course fee	€480 per participant
Group size	6–16 participants
Level	No previous debate experience required

The fee includes five days of teacher training, the Riga Learning Experience, course materials, practical teaching resources and a Certificate of Attendance.

Erasmus+ mobility

The course is designed for educators participating in European professional-development mobility, including Erasmus+ KA1 activities. Sending organisations remain responsible for confirming the eligibility of individual mobility costs under their own Erasmus+ grant agreement. The €480 course fee aligns with the Erasmus+ 2026 course-fee unit contribution of €80 per participant per day (6 days).

For Erasmus+ coordinators

We provide:

- Course programme and learning outcomes (this document)
- Participation confirmation
- Invoice for the sending organisation
- Attendance certificate
- Information required for the Mobility Agreement
- Support before arrival
- Guidance on accommodation and transport in Riga

How to register

Browse upcoming sessions and their current status at balticfoundation.lv/course-calendar.html, or contact us directly at info@balticfoundation.lv with your preferred dates and the number of participants. We will

confirm availability and send registration and invoicing details for your sending organisation.

Provider details

Organisation	Nodibin■jums "Baltic Foundation for Future Education"
Registration No.	40008362853
OID	E10443057
Location	Riga, Latvia
Contact	info@balticfoundation.lv

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